

Dr. Dirk R. Johnson

Professor of German
Department of Modern Languages
Hampden-Sydney College
Hampden Sydney, VA 23943
email: drjohnson@hsc.edu
<https://djohnsonhsc.wixsite.com/dirkjohnson>

Home Address:

2118 Avinity Loop
Charlottesville, VA 22902
434-414-5671 (cell)

Education

2000	Indiana University, Ph.D. (German Studies)
1996	Indiana University, M.A.
1989	University of Bonn, Magister (political science, German, and philosophy)
1985	Bowdoin College, B.A. (High Honors in German and history), <i>magna cum laude</i>
1983/4	University of Munich (Junior Year Abroad)

Employment

2016	Elliott Professor of German
2014	Professor of German, Hampden-Sydney College
2007	Associate Professor of German, Hampden-Sydney College
2001	Assistant Professor of German, Hampden-Sydney College
2000	Lecturer, Indiana University

COURSES TAUGHT

(Language Courses)

Beginning German
Intermediate German
Advanced Conversation and Composition

(Literature and Culture Courses taught)

Weimar Culture
The Viennese *fin-de-siècle*
Postwar German Short Fiction
The Writings of Friedrich Nietzsche
Patrick Süskind: Three Novels
The Holocaust: Representation in Postwar German Literature and Culture
Heinrich von Kleist: Short Fiction
Berlin: Literature and Culture, 1870-1930
German Drama: Lessing to Bernhard
Nietzsche and his Influence on *fin-de-siècle* Literature
The Turn of the Century and its Literary Innovators (Schnitzler, Musil, Kafka, Benn)
German Culture through Film

Georg Büchner: Life and Work
The *Historikerstreit*: From Habermas to Goldhagen
Youthful Rebellion in German Literature
German Popular Film and Culture
The Image of America in German Literature
German Literature Survey I (1 A.D. – 1775)
German Literature Survey II (1775 – 1930)

EXPERIENTIAL LANGUAGE IMMERSION

Director of the Münster Summer Program (2008-2026)

Recruited for, directed, and ran a five-week German language immersion program, with home stays, for intermediate and upper-level German students in Münster, Germany. Students were recruited from Hampden-Sydney College, Sweet Briar, Vassar College, Washington and Lee, William and Mary, Penn State University, and UNC-Chapel Hill.

RESEARCH

(Monograph)

(1) *Nietzsche's Anti-Darwinism*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2010.

Reviews:

- a) Keith-Ansell Pearson, *Journal of Nietzsche Studies* 42 (2011), 130-35.
- b) Benjamin Mitchell, *Isis* 102.3 (2011), 571-72.
- c) David Storey, *Environmental Philosophy* 8.2 (2011), 199-203.
- d) Matthew Day, *Quarterly Review of Biology* 87.1 (2012), 46.
- e) Christopher Cumo, *Canadian Journal of History* 47.1 (2012), 210-12.
- f) Adam C. Scarfe, *Journal of the History of Philosophy* 50.4 (2012), 621-22.
- g) Benjamin Alberts, *Nietzsche-Studien* 41.1 (2012), 474-81.
- h) Barry Allen, *New Nietzsche Studies* 8 3/4 (2011/2012), 165-70.
- i) Christian Benne, *Orbis litterarum* 68:2 (2013), 168–70.
- j) Ruth Burch, *The European Legacy* 18:7 (2013), 943-44.
- k) Thomas Waterton, *Pli: The Warwick Journal of Philosophy* 25 (2014), 201-06.
- l) Sven Gellens, [friedrichnietzsche.nl](https://www.friedrichnietzsche.nl/nietzsche-recensies/nietzsches-anti-darwinism/), August 21, 2020
<https://www.friedrichnietzsche.nl/nietzsche-recensies/nietzsches-anti-darwinism/>

(Book under review)

Nietzsche and Literature. (MS currently under peer review)

(Edited book)

Thus Spoke Zarathustra: The Edinburgh Annotated German-English Edition. (Co-editor: Yunus Tuncel) (proposal accepted by Edinburgh University Press)

(Book chapters)

Introduction to Nietzsche's *Thus Spoke Zarathustra*, Capstone Classics Edition (2022)

"*Zarathustra*: Nietzsche's Rendezvous with Eternity." In: *The New Cambridge Companion to Nietzsche*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press (2019).

"The Tragic Ambiguity, or the Ambiguous Tragedy, of Christa-Maria Sieland." In: *Totalitarianism on Screen: The Art and Politics of The Lives of Others*, ed. Carl Eric Scott and Flagg Taylor. University of Kentucky Press, 2014. 111-34.

(Articles)

"Translating Nietzsche's Atheism(s): A World beyond the Ethical Imperative." *The Agonist* 17:2 (2023), 47-53.

"Jaspers' Reading of Nietzsche's *Antichrist*." *Existenz* 15/2 (2020), 40-45.

"Nietzsche's Overman, or the Suggestive Power of Metaphor." *The Agonist* 11:2 (2018), 57-72.

"'Nietzsche und die Wissenschaft': vorläufige Bemerkungen." In: *Unkritische Massen? Offene Gesellschaft und öffentliche Vernunft*, ed. Stefan Wolf and Paul Marquering. Basel: LIT Verlag, 2016. 165-71.

"Was ist aus dem Nihilismus geworden?" *Nietzsche-Studien* 43 (2014), 29-39.

"A Nietzschean Naturalism or a Postmodernist Nietzsche? A Polemical Response." In: *Ohnmacht des Subjekts—Macht der Persönlichkeit*. Basel: Schwabe, 2014. 227-236.

"Modern vs. Ancient Science: Discussing Maudemarie Clark's *Nietzsche on Truth and Philosophy*." *Nietzsche-Studien* 42 (2013), 243-55.

"One Hundred Twenty-Two Years Later: Reassessing the Nietzsche-Darwin Relationship." *Journal of Nietzsche Studies* 44.2 (Summer 2013), 342-53.

"Gattung" (Species). *Nietzsche Wörterbuch Online*.

<https://www.universiteitleiden.nl/en/research/research-projects/humanities/nietzsche-dictionary-project>

“The ‘Future of Philosophy’ Revisited.” In: *Vernunft und Innovation*, eds. Antje Gimmler, Markus Holzinger, Lothar Knopp. Wilhelm Fink: München 2010. 255-260.

“Il sodalizio di Nietzsche con Paul Rée: ‘rééalismo superiore’ o réeallineamento filosofico?” *Rivista di filosofia* 2 (2005), 233-62. (“Nietzsche’s Partnership with Paul Rée: ‘Höherer Rééalismus’ or Philosophical Rééalignment?” Translated by Pietro Kobau.)

“On the Way to the Anti-Darwin: Nietzsche’s Darwinian Meditations in the Middle Period.” *Tijdschrift voor filosofie* 65 (2003), 657-78.

“Nietzsche’s Early Darwinism: The ‘David Strauss’ Essay of 1873.” *Nietzsche-Studien* 30 (2001), 62-79.

“The European Travel Game: Grammar Review in a Contextualized Setting.” *Die Unterrichtspraxis* 29 (1996), 250-52.

(Book Reviews)

I. *The Complete Works of Friedrich Nietzsche*, vol. 9, eds. Alan Schrift, Duncan Large and Adrian del Caro (Stanford University Press 2021); II. *Nietzsches Nachlass: Probleme und Perspektiven der Edition und Kommentierung*, eds. Barbara Besslich, Paolo D’Iorio, Katharina Grätz and Andreas Urs Sommer (De Gruyter 2023). (commissioned by The Agonist)

Conway, Daniel. *Nietzsche’s Beyond Good and Evil*. Edinburgh: Edinburgh University Press, 2014. *The Agonist* 18:2 (2024), 85-90.

Nietzsche and Literature. I. *Nietzsches Literaturen*, eds. Ralph Häfner, Sebastian Kaufmann, Andreas Urs Sommer: (De Gruyter 2019); II. *Nietzsche als Dichter: Lyrik – Poetologie – Rezeption* (De Gruyter 2018), eds. Katharina Grätz, Sebastian Kaufmann; III. Lecznar, Adam. *Dionysus after Nietzsche: The Birth of Tragedy in Twentieth-Century Literature and Thought* (Cambridge University Press 2020). *Nietzsche-Studien* 51(2022), 371-86.

Brooks, Shilo. *Nietzsche’s Culture War: The Unity of the Untimely Meditations*. New York: Palgrave Macmillan, 2018. *The Agonist* 15:1 (Fall 2021), 196-109.

Kornhaber, David. *The Birth of Tragedy from the Spirit of Philosophy: Nietzsche and the Modern Drama*. Evanston, IL: Northwestern University Press, 2016. *The Agonist* 14:1 (Spring 2020), 168-76.

Blue, Daniel. *The Making of Friedrich Nietzsche. The Quest for Identity, 1844-1869*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2016. *The Agonist* 12:1 (Fall 2018), 49-56.

Stegmaier, Werner. *Nietzsches Befreiung der Philosophie*. Berlin: De Gruyter, 2012. *The Agonist* 11:1 (Fall 2017), 31-34.

More, Nicholas. *Nietzsche’s Last Laugh: Ecce Homo as Satire*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2014. *The Agonist* 10:1 (Fall 2016).

Nietzsche's "Philosophy of Science." I. *Nietzsches Wissenschaftsphilosophie. Hintergründe, Wirkungen und Aktualität*, eds. Helmut Heit, Günter Abel, Marco Brusotti. Berlin/Boston: De Gruyter, 2012; II. *Nietzsche und die Wissenschaften. Natur-, geistes- und sozialwissenschaftliche Kontexte*, eds. Helmut Heit, Lisa Heller. Berlin/Boston: De Gruyter, 2014. *Nietzsche-Studien* 45:1 (2016), 268-79.

Panaïoti, Antoine. *Nietzsche and Buddhist Philosophy*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2013. *Mind* 124 (493) (2015), 377-80.

New Anglo-American Anthologies on Nietzsche. I. *A Companion to Nietzsche*, ed. Keith Ansell Pearson. Oxford: Blackwell Publishing, 2006; II. *The Oxford Handbook of Nietzsche*, eds. Ken Gemes and John Richardson. Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013; III. *A Companion to Friedrich Nietzsche. Life and Works*, ed. Paul Bishop. Rochester, NY: Camden House, 2012. *Nietzsche-Studien* 43 (2014), 225-36.

Makkreel, Rudolf A. and Frithjof Rodi, eds. *Wilhelm Dilthey, Selected Works/Volume II: Understanding the Human World* (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press, 2010), xxviii + 312 pp. *The European Legacy* 18:4 (July 2013), 943-44.

Moore, Gregory. *Nietzsche, Biology and Metaphor*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2002. *Journal of Nietzsche Studies* 35/36 (2008), 170-73.

(Translations)

Wilke, Manfred. "Fiction or Lived History? On the Question of the Credibility of *The Lives of Others*." Chapter of a book on *The Lives of Others*. University of Kentucky Press, 2014.

Langguth, Gerd. *In Search of Security: A Socio-Psychological Portrait of Today's Germany*. Praeger: Westport, CT, 1995. (212 pp.)

(Interviews)

Interviewed for: Patricia Koning, "Let's Go to the Movies: Film as a Teaching Tool." *The Language Educator* 6.4 (2011), 32-36.

Interview: "Nietzsche, Darwin, and Degeneration"
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G7t42CYUSCc>

(Additional professional service)

Manuscript evaluator for Cambridge University Press and De Gruyter

PRESENTATIONS

(Invited as Lecture Series Speaker)

"Nietzsche's 'Anti-Darwinism': The Origins and Development of an Antagonism." Barrett, The Honors College Lecture Series (Arizona State University, February 2010)

“Nietzsche’s ‘Anti-Darwinism’: The Origins and Development of an Antagonism.” Visiting Darwin Scholars Lecture Series (University of North Carolina-Wilmington, February 2009)

(International Presentations)

“Zarathustra’s Journey: Nietzsche’s Reconfiguration of the Human.” The XXIV World Congress of Philosophy (Beijing University, Beijing, China, August 2018)

“Nietzsche und die Wissenschaft: vorläufige Bemerkungen.” Speech at a Colloquium in Honor of Professor Walther Zimmerli (Humboldt University, Berlin, Germany, May 2015)

“Der Asketismus der Wissenschaft: Nietzsches Kritik der wissenschaftlichen Praxis als Schlusswort von GM III (23-28)?” Berliner-Nietzsche-Colloquium (Technical University of Berlin, Germany, July 2014)

“Was ist aus dem Nihilismus geworden?” Conference organized by the editorial board of Nietzsche Studien. (Hiddensee Island/Greifswald, Germany, April 2013)

“Nietzschean Naturalism or a Postmodernist ‘Nietzsche’? A Polemical Response.” International Nietzsche Conference in Naumburg (Nietzsche Documentation Center/Naumburg, Germany, October 2012)

“A Return to the Ancients: Nietzsche’s Excavation of the ‘Scientific’ Spirit of Antiquity.” Nietzsche Colloquium of Berlin: Nietzsche and Science (Technical University of Berlin, Germany, July 2010)

“‘Diese englischen Psychologen—was wollen sie eigentlich?’ Nietzsche’s Critique of the ‘Historians of Morals.’” Fifteenth Annual Conference of the Friedrich Nietzsche Society (Cambridge University, UK, September 2005)

“Translating Nietzsche’s Atheism(s): A World beyond the Ethical Imperative.” Fourteenth Annual Conference of the Friedrich Nietzsche Society (University of Sussex, UK, September 2004)

“‘Höherer Rééalismus’ or Philosophical Rééalignment?: Nietzsche, Paul Rée, and the Search for a Tradition.” Seventh Annual Conference of the Friedrich Nietzsche Society (St. Andrews, Scotland, September 1997)

(U.S. Presentations)

“‘The Life-Defining Moment’: German Study-Abroad for the Next Generation of Students.” (Education-Abroad Programs in German-Speaking Europe, Emory University, March 2013)

“*The Baader Meinhof Complex*: Communicating the RAF Legacy in Germany.” Center of the Liberal Arts (University of Virginia, March 2011)

“*The Lives of Others*: Classroom Approaches to the Film.” Association of the Teaching of Foreign Languages Conference (Boston, November 2010)

“One Hundred Twenty-Two Years Later: Reassessing the Nietzsche-Darwin Relationship.” American Philosophical Association Convention (New York City, December 2009)

“*The Lives of Others*: Classroom Approaches to the Film.” Foreign Language Association of Virginia Conference (Richmond, October 2009)

“A Reading of GM II, 1-5: Aspects of Nietzsche’s Challenge to Darwin’s Evolutionary Paradigm.” Nietzsche in New York (Hunter College, New York City, April 2009)

“*Zarathustra*’s Prologue: An Anti-Evolutionary Reading of the *Übermensch*.” Society for Phenomenology and Existential Philosophy (Pittsburgh, PA, October 2008)

“A ‘Species’ Apart: Nietzsche’s Challenge to the Darwinian *Gattungsbegriff*.” Mountain Interstate Foreign Language Conference (Roanoke, VA, October 2007)

(Professional Presentations)

Speech as President of Virginia-AATG at commemoration of Salem High School German Honors Society, Salem VA (June 2005)

“A World of Opportunity: The AATG-PAD Program and Its Student Study Trips to Germany,” FLAVA, Richmond, VA (October 2005)

ACADEMIC GRANTS AND HONORS

Elliott Professorship (2016-22)

Hampden-Sydney College Summer Research Grant
(2022/2021/2020/2019/2018/2017/2013/2011/2009/2007/2005/2004)

Oskar Seidlin Fellowship, Indiana University (1997-98)

Salaroglio Modern Foreign Language Scholarship, Indiana University (1997)

Indiana University Fellowship (1994-95)

High Honors in German, Bowdoin College (1985)

High Honors in History, Bowdoin College (1985)

James E. Bland History Prize, Bowdoin College (1985)

James Bowdoin Scholar, Bowdoin College (1985)

PROFESSIONAL APPOINTMENTS

Editorial Board Member, *The Agonist* (A Nietzsche Circle Journal) (2026-)

Advisory Board Member, The Karl Jaspers Society (2020-)

Advisory Board Member, The Hodges Foundation for Philosophical Orientation (2019-)

Director, German Summer in Münster Program, Hampden-Sydney College (2011-2026)

President, American Association of Teachers of German-Virginia Chapter (2005-07, 2010-12)

Executive Board Member, Foreign Language Association of Virginia, (2005-07, 2010-12)

Co-Instructor on the German Summer Program in Münster (2009)

AP German Reader, Lincoln, NE (June 2008)

Director, Virginia’s Governor’s German Language Academy (Summers 2006, 2007)

Chair, Virginia Chapter AATG-Pedagogical Exchange Service Committee (2003-05/2007)

COLLEGE SERVICE

(Chairing)

Chaired the Department of Modern Languages, 2010-2013

(Advising)

Freshmen advisor, every other year since 2004

(Committees)

German Search Committee (2025-2026)
Professional Development Committee (2020-23)
Experiential Learning Compass Study Abroad Pilot Course Coordinator (2022/2020)
Promotion & Tenure (2016-2019), Chair (2017-18)
Intercultural Affairs (2014-17)
French Search Committee (2017/2011)
Spanish Search Committee (2017/2011/2003)
Assessment Committee (2006/2008-11)
International Studies Committee (2003), Chair (2004-06)
Fitness Center Committee (2004)
German Honors Thesis Committee (Longwood University) (May 2003)
Foreign Language Placement Exams Sub-Committee (2001-02)

(Lectures & Presentations held)

Lecture for the viewing of *Das Experiment* (Hampden-Sydney College, April 2019)

“Propagating Lies, Uncovering the Truth: A Discussion of the Nazi Propaganda Film ‘Der Führer schenkt den Juden eine Stadt’”; with viewing of film (Hampden-Sydney College, October 2011)

Lecture for the viewing of *The Baader Meinhof Complex* (Hampden-Sydney College, April 2011); organized a campus-wide panel discussion on terrorism with viewing

Lecture for the viewing of *The Lives of Others* (Hampden-Sydney College, April 2009)

“Literature and Art under Wilhelm II” (as part of the series *Käthe Kollwitz: Literature and Film*) (Hampden-Sydney College Museum, October 2008)

(Lectures organized)

“*All Quiet on the Western Front*: A New Translation,” Professor Kurt Beals, University of Richmond (March 2025)

“Revisiting the Nazi Perpetrators,” Dr. Christopher Browning, UNC-Chapel Hill (February 2016)

“Democratizing Germany: Lessons from the Allied Occupation for the 21st Century,” Dr. Brian Puaca, Christopher Newport University (March 2015)

“Philosopher or Top Manager? The Role of Liberal Arts in International Business,” Professor Walther Zimmerli, President of Brandenburg Technical University-Cottbus, Germany (April 2013)

The Edge of Heaven, International Film and Lecture with the speaker Dr. Mine Eren, Randolph Macon College (October 2008)

(Other campus activities)

Hampden-Sydney German Club, founder and advisor

ADDITIONAL PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Wall Street Journal/Europe - Office Manager (Bonn, Germany) (1985-1992)

Managed the foreign office of the Wall Street Journal Europe with three full-time foreign correspondents. Accompanied journalists on trips; suggested stories; helped with translation and interpreting; established contacts; received by-line recognition for help with articles.

ESL Instructor with Berlitz and Inlingua Language Schools (Bonn, Germany) (1985-1992)

Research Associate. Assisted Prof. Dr. Hans-Peter Schwarz, Professor of Political Science, University of Bonn (1990-1991)

Research Assistant. Department of Political Science, University of Bonn (1988-89)

LANGUAGES

English: native

German: native

Italian: intermediate-mid

French: intermediate-mid

Latin: reading knowledge

REFERENCES

Dr. Julia Palmer, Chair of Modern Languages and Assoc. Professor of Spanish, Hampden-Sydney College, jpalmer@hsc.edu

Dr. Dieudonné Afatsawo, Assoc. Professor of Spanish, Hampden-Sydney College, dafatsawo@hsc.edu

Dr. Brett Martz, Assoc. Professor of German, Longwood University, martzbc@longwood.edu